

OCD THERAPY WORKBOOK

ERP Exercises for Breaking the Cycle

Evidence-Based Exposure & Response Prevention
Exercises to Reclaim Your Life from OCD

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OCD THERAPY WORKBOOK

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This workbook is for educational purposes and is not a substitute
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WHAT IS OCD?

Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD) is a neurobiological condition affecting approximately 1 in 40 adults. It is NOT about being neat or organized. OCD involves:

OBSSESSIONS: Unwanted, intrusive thoughts, images, or urges that cause significant distress. These feel 'sticky' - you cannot simply dismiss them. They are EGO-DYSTONIC, meaning they go AGAINST your values and desires.

COMPULSIONS: Repetitive behaviors or mental acts performed to reduce the anxiety caused by obsessions. They provide temporary relief but STRENGTHEN the OCD cycle long-term.

KEY FACTS:

- OCD is NOT your fault - it is a brain-based condition
- Having a thought does NOT mean you want it or will act on it
- Thought = just a thought, NOT a fact or prediction
- ERP (Exposure & Response Prevention) is the gold-standard treatment
- Recovery is possible - most people improve significantly with ERP

THIS WORKBOOK WILL HELP YOU:

1. Understand your specific OCD patterns
2. Build an ERP hierarchy (fear ladder)
3. Practice systematic exposures
4. Track your progress over 12 weeks
5. Develop relapse prevention strategies

IMPORTANT: This workbook works best alongside a therapist trained in ERP. If you do not have one, look for an OCD specialist at iocdf.org or nocd.com.

THE OCD CYCLE

Understanding the cycle is the first step to breaking it:

TRIGGER

(Internal or external event)



OBSESSION (Intrusive thought/image/urge)

Causes intense ANXIETY / DISTRESS



COMPULSION (Ritual / avoidance / reassurance)

Provides TEMPORARY relief



RELIEF (Short-term anxiety reduction)

But REINFORCES the cycle - OCD grows stronger



CYCLE REPEATS (obsession returns, often worse)

ERP BREAKS THE CYCLE by:

- Facing the trigger/obsession WITHOUT performing the compulsion
- Allowing anxiety to NATURALLY decrease (habituation)
- Teaching your brain: 'I can handle uncertainty and discomfort'

TYPES OF OCD

OCD can latch onto ANY theme. Common subtypes include:

CONTAMINATION OCD

- Fear of germs, illness, bodily fluids, chemicals
- Compulsions: excessive washing, avoiding 'contaminated' objects

HARM OCD

- Intrusive thoughts about hurting yourself or others
- Compulsions: checking, avoiding sharp objects, reassurance seeking
- NOTE: Having these thoughts does NOT mean you are dangerous

SYMMETRY / 'JUST RIGHT' OCD

- Need for things to feel 'even' or 'just right'
- Compulsions: arranging, counting, repeating until it feels right

RELIGIOUS / SCRUPULOSITY OCD

- Fear of sinning, blasphemy, or offending God
- Compulsions: excessive prayer, confessing, seeking reassurance

RELATIONSHIP OCD (ROCD)

- Constant doubt about love/attraction to partner
- Compulsions: comparing, testing feelings, seeking reassurance

OTHER COMMON THEMES:

- Pedophilia OCD (fear of being attracted to children - you are NOT)
- Existential OCD (obsessing about reality, consciousness)
- Health anxiety (fear of having a serious illness)
- Perfectionism OCD (fear of making mistakes)

MY OCD THEME(S): _____

My main obsessions: _____

My main compulsions: _____

EXPOSURE #1

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #2

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #3

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #4

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #5

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #7

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #8

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #9

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #10

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #12

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #13

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #14

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #15

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #17

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #18

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #19

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #20

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #22

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #23

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #24

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE #25

Fear/Obsession: _____

Anxiety Rating (SUDS 0-100):

Exposure Task (what I will DO): _____

Duration (how long I will stay in the exposure): _____

SUDS During: Start ____ | 5 min ____ | 10 min ____ | 15 min ____ | End ____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 1

Date: __/__/__ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: __/__/__ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: __/__/__ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 2

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 3

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 4

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 5

Date: __/__/__ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: __/__/__ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: __/__/__ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 6

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 7

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 8

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 9

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

EXPOSURE PRACTICE LOG - PAGE 10

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

Date: ___/___/___ Time: _____ Duration: _____

Trigger/Obsession: _____

Exposure Done: _____

Compulsion Resisted: _____

Anxiety BEFORE (0-100): _____ DURING (peak): _____ AFTER (end): _____

Rituals resisted? YES / NO If no, what did I do? _____

What I learned: _____

CHALLENGING INTRUSIVE THOUGHTS - Part 1

Intrusive thoughts are NORMAL. Everyone has them. The difference with OCD is that you get STUCK on them and assign them meaning.

EXERCISE: Thought Record

Intrusive thought #1: _____

What OCD says this means: _____

What the EVIDENCE says: _____

Probability this thought is true (0-100%): ____

What I would tell a friend with this thought: _____

Intrusive thought #2: _____

What OCD says this means: _____

What the EVIDENCE says: _____

Probability this thought is true (0-100%): ____

What I would tell a friend with this thought: _____

Intrusive thought #3: _____

What OCD says this means: _____

What the EVIDENCE says: _____

Probability this thought is true (0-100%): ____

What I would tell a friend with this thought: _____

REMINDER: The goal is NOT to make the thought go away.

The goal is to change your RELATIONSHIP to the thought.

CHALLENGING INTRUSIVE THOUGHTS - Part 2

COMMON COGNITIVE DISTORTIONS IN OCD:

1. **THOUGHT-ACTION FUSION:** Believing thinking = doing
'If I think about hurting someone, I might do it.'
REALITY: Thoughts are NOT actions. Period.
2. **OVERESTIMATION OF THREAT:** Believing danger is very likely
'If I touch that doorknob, I WILL get sick and die.'
REALITY: Your brain overestimates probability.
3. **INTOLERANCE OF UNCERTAINTY:** Needing 100% certainty
'I need to KNOW for sure that I locked the door.'
REALITY: 100% certainty is impossible about anything.
4. **OVERIMPORTANCE OF THOUGHTS:** 'If I think it, it matters'
'Having this thought means I am a terrible person.'
REALITY: Thoughts are mental noise, not identity.
5. **NEED TO CONTROL THOUGHTS:** Believing you should stop them
'Normal people do not have these thoughts.'
REALITY: Everyone has bizarre/disturbing thoughts.

MY MOST COMMON DISTORTION: _____

My rational response: _____

DEFUSION TECHNIQUES FOR OCD

DEFUSION = Creating distance between YOU and your thoughts.

You are NOT your thoughts. You are the one OBSERVING them.

TECHNIQUE 1: Label It

Say: 'I notice I am having the thought that...'

Or: 'There is my OCD again, telling me...'

Practice: _____

TECHNIQUE 2: Sing It

Sing your obsessive thought to 'Happy Birthday' or 'Jingle Bells'

This removes the emotional charge without suppressing the thought.

TECHNIQUE 3: Thank Your OCD

'Thank you, OCD, for trying to protect me. I do not need your help right now. I can handle this uncertainty.'

TECHNIQUE 4: The Leaves on a Stream

Imagine placing each thought on a leaf floating down a stream.

Watch it pass. Do not grab it. Do not push it away.

TECHNIQUE 5: Agree with OCD (Paradox)

'Maybe I DID leave the stove on. Maybe the house WILL burn down.'

Agreeing sarcastically takes away OCD's power.

TECHNIQUE 6: The Bully Metaphor

OCD is like a bully. The more you react, the more it bothers you.

Responding with 'Maybe, maybe not' starves the bully.

My favorite defusion technique: _____

BUILDING TOLERANCE FOR UNCERTAINTY

OCD thrives on your NEED FOR CERTAINTY. Recovery means learning to live with 'maybe' and 'I don't know for sure.'

UNCERTAINTY PRACTICE STATEMENTS (read daily):

'Maybe I did, maybe I didn't. I can handle not knowing.'

'I cannot be 100% sure, and that is okay.'

'Uncertainty is uncomfortable, not dangerous.'

'I choose to live my life even without certainty.'

'My need to know is the OCD talking, not reality.'

DAILY UNCERTAINTY EXPOSURES:

Practice tolerating uncertainty in LOW-stakes situations first:

- Leave a cabinet door slightly open. Do not check it.
- Send a text without re-reading it 5 times.
- Leave the house without checking the lock extra times.
- Make a decision without researching exhaustively.
- Say 'I don't know' when asked a question.

MY UNCERTAINTY PRACTICE LOG:

Day 1: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

Day 2: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

Day 3: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

Day 4: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

Day 5: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

Day 6: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

Day 7: _____ Anxiety (0-10): ____

RELAPSE PREVENTION PLAN

OCD is a chronic condition. Flare-ups are NORMAL, not failure.
Having a plan helps you respond quickly when OCD tries to return.

MY WARNING SIGNS THAT OCD IS FLARING UP:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

COMMON RELAPSE TRIGGERS:

- Stress / major life changes
- Sleep deprivation
- Illness / hormonal changes
- Stopping ERP practice ('I am cured now')
- Starting compulsions 'just this once'

MY PLAN WHEN I NOTICE A FLARE-UP:

1. Acknowledge it: 'My OCD is acting up. This is temporary.'
2. Resume daily ERP exercises immediately
3. Re-read this workbook (especially pages 3-5)
4. Contact my therapist: _____
5. Reach out to support: _____

MAINTENANCE PLAN (even when doing well):

- Weekly: Do at least 1 planned exposure from my hierarchy
- Daily: Practice defusion when intrusive thoughts appear
- Monthly: Review this workbook and update my hierarchy
- Ongoing: Continue therapy as recommended

MY SUPPORT TEAM

Recovery is not a solo journey. List your support system:

THERAPIST/COUNSELOR

Name: _____
Phone: _____
Email: _____
Next appointment: _____

PSYCHIATRIST (if applicable)

Name: _____
Phone: _____
Medication: _____
Next appointment: _____

TRUSTED FAMILY MEMBER

Name: _____
Phone: _____
What they know about my OCD: _____

TRUSTED FRIEND

Name: _____
Phone: _____
How they can help: _____

SUPPORT GROUP

Group name: _____
Meeting time: _____
Contact: _____

CRISIS RESOURCES

IOCDF: iocdf.org _____
N OCD App: nocd.com _____
Crisis line: 988 _____
My emergency plan: _____

MY PROGRESS TRACKER

Track your SUDS ratings over time to see improvement!

Rate your OVERALL OCD severity each week (0-100):

Week 1: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 2: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 3: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 4: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 5: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 6: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 7: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 8: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 9: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 10: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 11: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

Week 12: SUDS ____ Exposures completed: ____ Compulsions resisted: ____

MILESTONES TO CELEBRATE:

- ☐ Completed my first exposure without ritualizing
- ☐ SUDS dropped below 50 for a previously feared situation
- ☐ Went a full day without compulsions
- ☐ Told someone about my OCD
- ☐ Recognized OCD in real-time and chose not to engage
- ☐ Completed all items on my hierarchy
- ☐ Had a flare-up and recovered using my plan

WEEK 1

Focus: Foundation: Learn about OCD, complete hierarchy, start lowest item

Schedule: Daily: Read about OCD cycle | 3x/week: Practice lowest hierarchy item

Notes: _____

WEEK 2

Focus: Building momentum: Continue lowest items, add next level

Schedule: Daily: Defusion practice | 3x/week: Exposure to items rated 20-35

Notes: _____

WEEK 3

Focus: Increasing challenge: Move up hierarchy, reduce safety behaviors

Schedule: Daily: Uncertainty tolerance | 4x/week: Exposure to items rated 35-50

Notes: _____

WEEK 4

Focus: Pushing through: Tackle moderate items, resist all compulsions

Schedule: Daily: No compulsions | 4x/week: Exposure to items rated 50-60

Notes: _____

WEEK 5

Focus: Harder exposures: Face fears that feel very challenging

Schedule: Daily: Imaginal exposure | 4x/week: Exposure to items rated 60-70

Notes: _____

WEEK 6

Focus: High difficulty: Tackle items you thought impossible

Schedule: Daily: Agree with OCD | 5x/week: Exposure to items rated 70-80

Notes: _____

WEEK 7

Focus: Near the top: Face highest hierarchy items

Schedule: Daily: Full uncertainty acceptance | 5x/week: Items rated 80-90

Notes: _____

WEEK 8

Focus: Peak challenge: Hardest items on your list

Schedule: Daily: Live as if OCD is lying | 5x/week: Items rated 90-100

Notes: _____

WEEK 9

Focus: Consolidation: Repeat peak items, vary contexts

Schedule: Daily: Generalize exposures | Review and update hierarchy

Notes: _____

WEEK 10

Focus: Maintenance: Continued practice, reduce frequency

Schedule: 3x/week: Varied exposures | Build relapse prevention plan

Notes: _____

WEEK 11

Focus: Independence: Self-directed ERP, handle flare-ups

Schedule: 2x/week: Maintenance exposures | Practice responding to new triggers

Notes: _____

WEEK 12

Focus: Graduation: Celebrate progress, plan ongoing maintenance

Schedule: Weekly: One planned exposure | Monthly: Review and adjust plan

Notes: _____